

Palm Treo 650

The 650's Better!

The upgraded sibling of the popular Treo 600 (reviewed in the December 2004 issue of *Digit*), the 650 boasts of some significant enhancements—really making it worth a *dekk*o! Major upgrades in the new model include a faster processor, an upgraded operating system, EDGE connectivity, a better screen, Bluetooth support, removable battery and video capture functionality—which was lacking in the Treo 600.

The Treo 650 is powered by an Intel PXA270 312 MHz CPU, running version 5.4 of Palm OS. The quadband GSM/GPRS device offers about 23 MB of user-available memory—expandable through the SDIO (Secure Digital Input Output) slot.

Installed applications include Phone, VersaMail, Web browser, Camera, RealPlayer, and World Clock apart from standard PIM applications such as Contacts, Calendar, Tasks and Memos. RealPlayer can be used to play MP3 files, but you would need an SD/MMC card to store the tracks, it does not play from internal memory.

The Treo 650, as was the case with its predecessor, is designed for single-handed operation using the five-way navigator and other hardware buttons. However, you need to use both hands (thumbs, in fact) while typing text on the QWERTY keyboard. The phone operation is smooth, and there are no issues as far as voice clarity is concerned.

The screen vibrancy is excellent with colours reproduced well. The inbuilt camera with 2X digital zoom captures stills and videos at an acceptable quality, if there's enough light.

The rechargeable lithium ion battery will give you enough juice to last for three to four days with standard usage, but will be greatly reduced if you play media files, games, or leave the Bluetooth perpetually switched on.

Surely worth considering, if you want a device that lets you stay connected anywhere in the world, and offers business and entertainment functionality, all-in-one.



Company **Esource Global**
 Price **Rs 36,000**
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Rating 

MSI's P4N Diamond And NX6800GT SLI

A Real Diamond Of A Motherboard!

MSI's P4N Diamond SLI motherboard ships with nVidia's GeForce 4 Intel Edition chipset. The board features Scalable Link Interface (SLI) technology for plugging in two graphic cards. This is the first SLI board for the Intel platform from nVidia.

The P4N Diamond offers six SATA ports, and is RAID 0, 1, 0+1 and 5 capable. It also features two Gigabit Ethernet ports, up to 10 USB 2.0 ports and two FireWire ports. On the aural front, the board comes with a dedicated 24-bit sound chip from Creative that is equivalent to the Creative Live! series. The board is also touted to be dual-core processor ready.

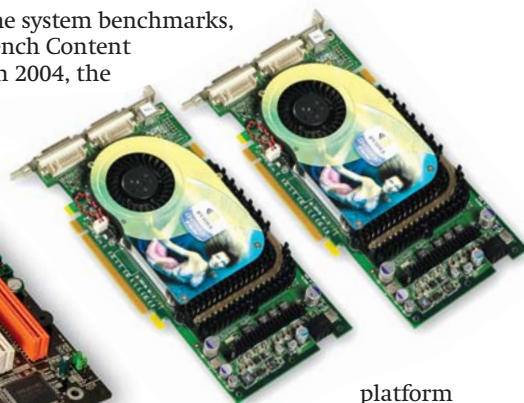
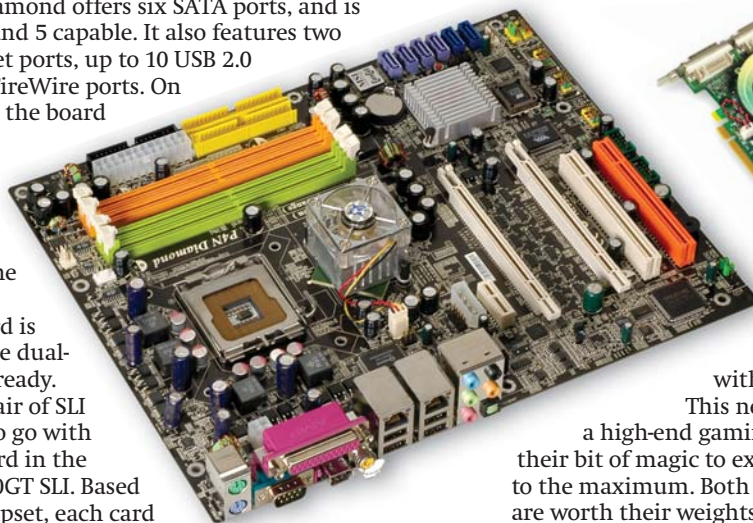
MSI has a pair of SLI graphic cards to go with the motherboard in the form of NX6800GT SLI. Based on the 6800 chipset, each card offers two DVI connectors and a composite video out.

The test platform we used was a Pentium IV 3.6 GHz processor, 1 GB of Micron DDR2 RAM running at 533 MHz in dual-channel configuration, and a 250 GB hard drive from Maxtor. We loaded the Forceware 71.89 drivers from nVidia, along with the latest system drivers for Windows XP. The bench returned some of the best results ever; with scores of 7905 and 19170 in 3DMark05 and 3DMark03 respectively.

Doom 3 returned an impressive 99.6 fps at 1024 x 768 and 86.5 fps at 1600 x 1200. Halo also returned impressive scores of 106.94 at 1024 x 768 and 91.37 at 1600 x 1200. The gameplay

in all the games was smooth, and the card played them effortlessly when the resolutions were cranked up, and even with full AA.

In fact, the system benchmarks, such as ZDBench Content Creation 2004, the



platform returned a score of 32.4, which is on par with AMD Athlon 64-based systems.

This new nVidia-based platform is meant for a high-end gaming machine. As usual, MSI has done their bit of magic to exploit the potential in the nVidia chips to the maximum. Both the P4N Diamond, and the NX6800GT are worth their weights in gold.

The P4N Diamond is priced at Rs 18,500, and the NX6800GT pair of graphic cards will set you back by Rs 57,000. Although expensive, you have to see it perform to believe it!

Company **Micro Star India**
 Price **Rs 18,500 (MSI P4N Diamond Motherboard), Rs 57,000 (MSI NX6800GT)**
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Rating 